Entropy by Christine Deitner

Logline: Alice, new to love and possessed of rather naïve notions about it, falls hard for Jack, a man with a conflicted view of the world and love's place in it, resulting in a whirlwind love affair that wrecks havoc on both lovers and their closest friends, testing their very sense of self and their understanding of the world.

Synopsis [one to two pages]:
The construct is that of a memory play. At the start, Alice enters the playing space with a stack of journals and poems filled with her thoughts about Jack, her friend Katherine, his friend Christopher, and what happened to them in their past relationship. Using these papers and their thoughts as a gateway, Alice transports herself, and us, back to the story of her love affair with a boy named Jack. As a young college girl with the world at her feet and hardly a negative thought in her head, Alice had done just fine without a man in her life. She was not ruled by her sex drive as her crasser and harder friend Katherine tended to be. Yet one night Alice happens to meet Jack in a bar - a man well-versed in the guise of the player. Alice's complete lack of guile takes Jack by surprise. Her innocence attracts him, and the two develop a relationship that plunges them deeper into feelings of love for each other than either one could have predicted.

Both Katherine and Christopher are skeptical of their professed adoration, Katherine believing there is nothing much about Jack to adore; Christopher suspicious of the credit Jack appears to be giving Alice for when he looks into her, he finds there's not much there. Christopher and Katherine begin a relationship of their own, standing in sharp contrast to Alice and Jack, they are more confrontational as illustrated in their choice of dialogue from *The Taming of the Shrew* to express the arc of their story. Eventually their cynicism wears thin as they spend more time with Alice and Jack. Christopher finds that his friend's behavior towards Alice grows more and more insufferable to him. Jack finds Katherine's hardened nature alluring, and pursues her in his own wolf-like manner. Though Alice and Jack have made a commitment close to marriage, Jack subscribes to certain philosophical ideas that he believes leaves him unaffected by human emotions such as guilt or jealousy, and he takes action with abandon and little thought of the consequences.

Alice's Mother finds fault with the couple, which works in conflict with Alice's nature as the girl who always listened to Mother when she told her what to do. Alice's determination to break free of her Mother's overbearing sense of righteousness shakes Mother's foundation. She finds she fears for her daughter's well-being yet is herself completely incapable of expressing that fear to Alice for it would reveal her humanity. Revealing her emotions would reveal the chink in her armor, and the whole thing would fall apart right quick.

Jack and Alice host a dinner party for Katherine and Christopher, during which it becomes clear that Jack is pursuing an affair with Katherine as a means to match his philosophy. Christopher and Alice are both hurt by this. Alice tries to connect intellectually with Jack, and fails, which sends her reeling into an understanding of their relationship and how close she is to losing him. Now enamored with Katherine, Jack decides, against his love for her, that he has no use for Alice and contrives to make him leave her. Destroyed by this, Alice turns to Christopher for some consolation, but her devotion to Jack stirs up feelings of guilt and she begins to question the whole construct of her life. Christopher tries to convince Jack to let down his philosophical façade and admit he's human and therefore faulty, but Jack continues to resist all healthy feelings in the relationship which ultimately leads to him pushing Katherine aside. Christopher, angered by the situation and what it is doing to him, engages Alice and Katherine in a cruel Shakespearean game wherein he challenges both their integrity and their love for him. Katherine, now bereft of both Alice and Jack finds herself vulnerable, a feeling she is not comfortable with. Alice discovers Jack is truly not as special as she had passionately hoped he might be, yet still finds it hard to keep away from him. Katherine and Christopher reconnect, in a failed attempt to recover their initial *Taming of the Shrew* playfulness - they find they are wounded and both surrender their anger in a moment of peace. In search of the same peace, Alice confronts her Mother about past actions that Mother insists she does not remember.

Throughout the play, the four young friends are completely aware of where this is all going – all of history has already happened. They take on dual roles of being both in the play, unaware of the destination, and outside of it, mercilessly sure of the outcome. Katherine and Christopher take on several roles to move the story forward, in spite of themselves. As they explain the concept of Entropy, Alice and Jack reconnect to exchange belongings, and close this chapter of their lives. Alice, back in the role of guide, no longer in the role of her once younger life, speaks of her doomed love, Jack's lasting influence, and her seemingly never-ending desire to retain the warmth of him, even after

all that has happened. Alice says her goodbyes, considers bringing the papers back with her offstage. In the end, she leaves them where they lie, as they have lain throughout the story. Alice leaves with a clean slate, though its clear the experience has left its mark on all of them.

Character Breakdown:
There are five characters total. Considering the aspect of the memory play, the actors may be in their early to mid-thirties, save for Mother, who remains the age of memory.
ALICE: Our heroine. Early 20's, female in the course of the memory play. In reality, in her 30's.
JACK: Our hero. Early 20's, male in the play – in reality in his 30's
CHRISTOPHER PETRUCHIO: Jack's best friend. Early 20's, male. More sensible than Jack. Same age convention applies, - they are young in memory, older and wiser in life.
KATHERINE SKY: Alice's best friend. Early 20's, female. Not as pretty as Alice, but stronger.
MOTHER: Alice's mother, 40's, female. A lecturing expert on Etiquette.

Set and any Special Production requirements:
The action took place in New York City, more specifically, the West Village in and around West 3rd street between MacDougal and 6th in the 1990's – however the time period is only important to the characters as a time when there was no K-Mart in Astor Place, no Disney in Times Square. A New York of a slightly rawer character, just about ready to bleed.

The set should be comprised of an open space defined by lighting and the use of at least one slide projector rather than walls, curtains or a multitude of props. No great pains should be taken to hide the slide projectors, lighting sources, television set or scene changes, as they may come to pass. Perhaps there is a small table for Jack's computer, and Alice's telephone; a podium USL for Mother with it's own light to read by; a raised platform a la English Fair for Christopher and Katherine in 'Shrew', which can also be used as a bed.

Each character, save Alice, has a space of their own where they can retreat to communicate their innermost feeling to the audience. The audience will, as a result, sometimes find themselves the unwitting confidants for each of our four young lovers.
When Mother addresses the audience, they are rather being taught than taking on the role of listener and teacher.

At rise, one microphone stand and the small table takes the space DSR.

When each of the characters take on the personae of literary figures, their physicality and tone ought to change – but to exactly what extent, that is up to the production

Production History:
A staged reading of the play was presented to an audience in Northampton, MA at A.P.E. in the fall of 1998. Another reading of the play for an audience of eight was presented in Los Angeles in June, 2006.

Playwrights Bio:
Christine Deitner has worked professionally in the theater as a Director, Playwright, Stage Manager, Production Manager, Producer and Assistant Lighting Designer. In addition, she appeared Off-Broadway as an actress, joining Actor's Equity Association in 1994. She wrote and directed *Anus Mundi* which premiered in New York City to some acclaim and her work as director on *Watered Down* was featured in the New York Times. She also worked as Producer, First Assistant Director and Script Supervisor on short films in NYC and LA. In addition, her play *Entropy* was granted a performance slot at the coveted A.P.E. performance space in Northampton, MA where it received it's first staged reading and was well received. She was interviewed by the Daily Hampshire Gazette about this reading as well as her decision to move from New York back to her hometown.

After living in New York for nine years, Christine's friends back in New England brought her into the music business as Office Tour Manager for three small bands, and then Assistant Production Manager for three music venues: the Iron Horse, Pearl Street and the Calvin Theatre, all in Northampton, MA. She also stage managed at the Calvin Theatre before taking on the job of Production Manager and Technical Director for both CityStage and Symphony Hall, two touring venues housing varying from national tours to the local dance recital. There her work with I.A.T.S.E. Local 53 garnered her enough experience and savvy to land a position on her first tour, *Showboat*, which

led to nearly six years of travel as both Stage and Company Manager for production across North America and Europe.

Christine attended New York University, where she received her B.F.A. in Directing and Acting with minors in English and Film Studies. She graduated an Honors Scholar and also received a Founder's Day award in recognition of her academic achievement. Having made the transition from theater roadie back to a more settled life, she followed her many friends from NYU to Los Angeles, where she currently holds the position of Associate Producer with the film *Dirt! The Movie*, an official selection for Sundance 2009 in the US Documentary Competition. Prior to her work getting dirty, Christine worked for Producer Richard Raynis as a Production Coordinator for *The Simpsons Movie* and *The Simpsons Game* as well as Production Supervisor on *The Simpsons Ride* at Film Roman, Burbank. Two of her screenplays, *Digressions and Intuitions* and *A Horizontal Fall* have done a fair job in competition, making it to the semifinals in the WriteMovies.com International Writing Competition #12 while *Digressions* also rated a 'consider' in the 2007 AAA Competition and screenplay *The One-Nighter* made it to the Semi-Finals in the 2008 Scriptapalooza Screenwriting Competition.

Writing Sample [representative/best ten pages of the play – taken from the middle….]:

SCENE SIX

*LIGHTS UP on Katherine going through Alice's papers at the podium. She grows more and more exasperated in her attempt to find what she's looking for***.**

KATHERINE:
[*to the Audience*]
Don't look at me! I tried to talk her out of it.

Slide: **After the fiasco…**

Katherine reads the slide. It angers her, and she throws something at the image.

Slide: **Don't say I didn't warn you.**

Katherine, defeated, turns back to the Audience.

KATHERINE:
She's in love. What can I say? There is still much to tell. I am only concerned with telling it 'right'. Remember, it is all-important - in different ways. There is no telling how to proceed – what will be gained, what lost. Later… now we can see. Now we can know.

Something is bothering Katherine.
Very serious, she works hard to make the Audience understand.

KATHERINE:
I only wish to make it clear to you that I always operated with the best intentions… however misguided. BUT…

Slide: **"We don't see things as they are, we see them as we are."**

KATHERINE:
Right.

Katherine begins to speak again. Christopher as Petruchio enters interrupting her.

CHRISTOPHER [Petruchio]:
Good morrow, Kate, for that's your name, I hear.

Katherine, mortified at being caught at the podium, freezes.

Slide: **The Taming of the Shrew [Part Two]**

Christopher and Katherine read the slide. Then Katherine runs to join Christopher.

KATHERINE [Kate]:
Well have you heard, but something hard of hearing.
They call me Katherine that do talk of me.

They continue on with the scene exactly as written until…

KATHERINE [Kate]:
Yours, if you talk of tales, and so farewell.

CHRISTOPHER [Petruchio]:
What, with my tongue in your tail? Nay, come again, good Kate, I am a gentleman.

KATHERINE [Kate]:
That I'll try.

Katherine strikes him HARD. Then she turns on her heel and runs out.
Christopher stands, stunned, still – and suddenly in love.

Slide: **Love!**

CHRISTOPHER:
I am euphoric! I write on the back cover of my Art History Reader, because I have no paper! I am upstairs at Café Milano, with caffeine pumping in my veins and oh! – it is such a fantastic feeling – such a wondrous thing to be here right now! The sunlight streaming in through the skylight, blotted out intermittently by fast moving, glorious clouds and Katherine! You and I together!
I love you.
Moments ago, as I sat staring wide-eyed at those clouds, I was aware of a strange and beautiful sensation. It seemed as if I could mentally switch perspective to such an extent that I could feel the physical change. I felt the earth's rotation, I felt it moving in its orbit and all of the life on it moving along with me. Rings and rings of energy encircling one another, ripples of motion in some cosmic pond…

ALICE and **JACK** and **KATHERINE [from offstage, various]:**
Amen brother!

CHRISTOPHER:
Nothing was belittled in the process! Humanity, nor myself – nothing was squashed out of significance - no – on the contrary, the terrestrial small and the universal large were connected with motion. The movement of the earth around the sun at a million miles per hour matching the movement of the blood in my veins… the pumping of my heart propelling a planet along!
Katherine…! Alice… Katherine! I love you!

SCENE SEVEN

LIGHTS UP on Alice, Jack and Mother at the dinner table. They eat in strained silence.

MOTHER:
What an interesting apartment. The shower in the kitchen - and the toilet is where exactly?

ALICE:
Down the hall.

MOTHER:
Oh you can't stay here darling. We'll have to find you someplace else.

ALICE:
But I like it here.

MOTHER:
You couldn't possibly. No daughter of mine would settle for this.

JACK:
She said she was fine.

MOTHER:
Yes but I've known her longer which means I know her better. And I know this is not right.

ALICE:
Please pass the asparagus.

MOTHER:
I will say this is delicious. When did you have the time to make this darling?

ALICE:
I didn't. It was Jack.

MOTHER:
Well you do impress after all.

JACK:
I guess I do.

MOTHER:
Tomorrow we'll find you another place.

ALICE:
I'm staying with Jack.

MOTHER:
I'll call Sylvia. She'll know where to look.

JACK:
SHE SAID she's staying with me. Here. And that's final.

All three try to eat. Beat. Then Mother cannot help herself.

MOTHER:
When you get a bigger place, I can give you that dining room set. You always loved that dining room set. Ever since you were a child.

Jack struggles to control his temper. Alice doesn't know what to say.

MOTHER:
I must say, this fish is simply delightful. You just have to give me the recipe.

SCENE EIGHT

LIGHTS UP on Katherine and Christopher, sitting listless, without direction. .

KATHERINE:
What do you suppose they're doing now?

CHRISTOPHER:
Fucking.

KATHERINE:
Don't be crude.

CHRISTOPHER:
You asked.

The two sit, thinking.
Then.Katherine begins to softly sing an old folk tune.

KATHERINE:
Tell me why the stars do shine, Tell me why the ivory twines,
Tell me why the sky's so blue… and I will tell you just why I love you.

Christopher looks at her, then joins in – even harmonizing.

KATHERINE and **CHRISTOPHER:**
Because God made the stars to shine, Because God made the ivory twine,
Because God made the sky so blue… Because God made you, that's why I love you.

CHRISTOPHER:
Nice.

KATHERINE:
For what it's worth… yeah.

Katherine turns upstage, asking the slide projectors -

KATHERINE:
What do you have to say for yourself?

The slide projector turns on, but no words appear.
Then…

Slide: **Lecture Two. When Young Women are Not Particular.**

SCENE NINE

LIGHTS UP on Mother at the podium.
She is very distracted by thoughts of her daughter as she lectures this time.

As she speaks, Jack, Alice, Katherine and Christopher set up for the dinner party.
As they do, Katherine tries to avoid Jack as Christopher tries to get closer to Alice.

MOTHER:
Continuous pursuit of thrill and consequent craving for greater and greater excitement gradually produce the same results as that which a drug produces in an addict. Promiscuous crowding and shoving, petting and cuddling have the same cheapening effect as that produced on merchandise which has, through constant handling, become faded and rumpled, smudged or frayed and thrown out on the bargain counter in a marked-down lot. One danger of a certain dominant iconoclasm that might be called the chaperon-less attitude is that values may be appreciated too late. And when one of these reckless squanderers longs for something of real value to give, there may be nothing left worth giving.

Mother lights a cigarette, looking out into the Audience.

MOTHER:
Any questions?

She exhales smoke as LIGHTS dim.

SCENE TEN

Slide: **A MAD Tea Party**

LIGHTS UP on Alice, Jack, Katherine and Christopher seated around the dinner table.
Throughout the meal, Jack flirts shamelessly with Katherine, who grows to enjoy it.

Alice does her best to ignore it. Christopher watches on with a mix of growing envy towards Jack and new feelings of tenderness for Alice.

JACK:
In five to ten years, everything in the world will be owned by two men. John Reed and Bill Gates. McCitiburger with cheese. And there'll be no more art, no more theatre. There will only be clip art.

KATHERINE:
These people getting caught up in their own spider webs – no – that's not right. These… ropes that hold them into place. It just makes you sick to watch. Unless you're fifteen years old and rich and beautiful and it's all because they're guilty or something that makes them stay in place.

JACK:
[*to Katherine*]
You have the most amazing mouth.

ALICE:
More wine anyone?

JACK:
[*to Katherine*]
Smile for me.

CHRISTOPHER:
That was a pretty fabulous meal, Alice.

ALICE:
Oh, that wasn't me. That was Jack. He's something of a chef, you know.

CHRISTOPHER:
Oh that's right. Then I have one small criticism to make.

Jack tears himself away from Katherine. Katherine, relieved at the break, drinks.

JACK:
Oh? Well what is it?

Christopher says nothing. He simply looks at Jack until Jack realizes he's squaring off.

JACK:
You do not get to do that to me. You do not get to do that to me! I am trying to be polite.

Christopher laughs.

CHRISTOPHER:
You don't take care of yourself.

JACK:
Why should I? Who do I have to impress? What about yourself?

Jack and Christopher glare at one another. Alice breaks the silence with small talk.

ALICE:
Well, I'm just tired of not having money. I mean honestly, I just wasn't meant not to have money.

Jack laughs cruelly.

KATHERINE:
What is so funny about that, Henry - Jack?

JACK:
You're just not meant *not* to have money. That has got to be the dumbest thing I ever heard. I'm not meant *not* to have money either, but that doesn't mean I cry about it.

Beat. All are suspended as if hoping they do not have to proceed.

CHRISTOPHER:
Oh God! Are we really going to do this?

Katherine leans across the table to Alice, grabbing her hand.

KATHERINE:
I have no designs on going home with him June – Alice. I swear to God, that's the truth.

Beat. Then Jack begins to slide his hand between Katherine's legs.
Katherine lets go of Alice's hand and sits back in her chair, enjoying Jack's touch..

ALICE [**as Alice in Wonderland**]:
"Dear, dear! How queer everything is today! And yesterday things went on just as usual. I wonder if I've been changed in the night?"

Beat. Katherine begins to MOAN quietly. Christopher, desperate to distract Alice tries this...

CHRISTOPHER [**as Rodolphe from Madame Bovary**]
"So – I just get more and more and more engulfed in gloom as time goes on…"

ALICE [as Emma Bovary]:
"You do? I thought of you as being very jolly."

CHRISTOPHER [as Rodolphe]:
"Of course – that's the impression I give; I've learned to wear a mask of mockery when I'm with other people. But many's the time I've passed a cemetery in the moonlight and asked myself if I wouldn't be better off lying there with the rest…"

Katherine's moans grow louder.

ALICE [as Emma]:
"Oh! And what about your friends? Have you no thought for them?"

CHRISTOPHER [as Rodolphe]:
"My friends? What friends? Have I any? Who cares anything about me?"

Alice and Christopher cast a glance at Jack, who is transfixed by Katherine's passion.
They quickly become uncomfortable and look back at one another.

CHRISTOPHER [as Rodolphe]:
"Do you really not know that there exist souls that are ceaselessly in torment? That are driven now to dreams, now to action, driven from the purest passions to the most orgiastic pleasure? No wonder we fling ourselves into all kinds of fantasies and follies!"

ALICE [as Emma]:
"We poor women don't have even that escape."

CHRISTOPHER [as Rodolphe]:
"A poor escape, since it doesn't bring happiness."

ALICE [as Emma]:
"But do we ever find happiness?"

CHRISTOPHER [as Rodolphe]:
"Yes, it comes along one day."

Katherine COMES, and Jack glows, triumphant.

Alice and Christopher gaze into each other's eyes. Christopher takes Alice's hand. It appears as though the room melts away, and it is just the two of them in torment.

CHRISTOPHER:
I don't know how you do it.

Alice nearly dissolves into tears. She fights off the breakdown with words.

ALICE [as Alice in Wonderland]:
"It was much pleasanter at home – when one wasn't always growing larger and smaller and being ordered about by mice and rabbits. I almost wish I hadn't gone down that rabbit hole… and yet… and yet…"

CHRISTOPHER:
I want you, and one day I will have you. It cannot be denied. I love you, Alice. God, I love you.

Alice and Christopher almost kiss. Jack glances over and discovers them close together.

Jack suddenly lunges across the table and pins Christopher to the ground.

JACK:
Why are you upsetting my wife?

ALICE:
Jack – no!

CHRISTOPHER:
I didn't mean anything!

ALICE:
Jack – please!

JACK:
[*to Alice, screaming*]
Lower your voice! The neighbors will hear!

KATHERINE:
Oh God. I thought it was okay! Of all places – here – I thought it was okay!

Jack lifts Christopher and throws him down.

ALICE:
JACK!

CHRISTOPHER:
<u>*I*</u> – was upsetting your wife.

JACK:
I'm just not nostalgic enough tonight to be interested in authenticity.

KATHERINE:
It didn't mean anything!

ALICE:
We do what we like! We sleep naked here!

KATHERINE:
It didn't mean anything? Oh God!

Katherine begins to hyperventilate, to panic. Alice watches her, disturbed by this..

JACK:
[*almost lovingly, to Katherine*]
Let it go. Let it all go.

ALICE:
How about a drink?

Jack crosses to Alice, leaving Katherine alone.

JACK:
Yes, please.

Katherine goes to Christopher, seeking comfort.

KATHERINE:
I thought of all places, it would be all right!

CHRISTOPHER:
[*to Jack*]
You – are unbelievable.

JACK:
In every dick, there is a little bit of human.

Beat. All is silent

.
ALICE:
It's late. Why don't you two stay the night?

Christopher and Katherine look at each other, both near tears.

SCENE ELEVEN

Alice and Jack lie in bed together – he on his stomach, his head resting on his forearm.

Slide: **The attempt and not the deed confounds us.**

JACK:
My dreams have been especially vibrant this week. In one, I was in an airplane traveling through beautiful mountains. We came upon the most gorgeous city… the skyscrapers were thrillingly tall and needle-like. One of them was shaped peculiarly and the place stung me with shockwaves of recognition, though I also knew, all at once, that I had never seen it before. The mass of humanity was daunting, and beautiful, spread out below. I felt my whole heart

JACK [cont'd]:
stretch out… our plane was flying too low, right between the tops of the two tallest buildings and past a hive-like building with yellow pods connected to it like a molecular model. We swung out over the water and the mountains, across the inlet to turn about and make our descent… but the angle was too sharp. I remember wondering briefly whether the pilot realized what she was doing.
And then we were approaching the bright blue water flecked with dark green shapes of movement and plunging, plowing into depths and certain death. It was gorgeous and stunning.

ALICE:
I had a dream last night. I was in the shower, and I was shampooing my hair – only my hair wasn't hair, it was a head of lettuce. And I began to break pieces of my head of hair off, letting it fall to the ground, all getting washed in the tub water. I got out of the shower, only I didn't know what to do with the lettuce, so I made a salad, and served it to our closest friends. Only they weren't our friends at all.

Jack turns to look at Alice. He shakes his head, bemused.

JACK:
You're a sweet girl.

ALICE:
I love you.

Jack smiles at her [maybe he yawns as he says the following]. He turns his head away.

JACK:
I love you.

Jack turns his head and falls asleep, leaving Alice starkly alone.

ALICE:
Oh no. And now I am alone again beside you. Alone this time because I cannot show you this.
I have something I can't explain you see because THAT'S NOT WHAT HAPPENED - - - and it never is.
I want to force feed you my way of seeing things – open your mouth God Damn it.
And is that all there is? These moments of connection? These – windows of opportunity that open and close where two – or three – are…
Having broken into one of these windows, I watch it contract around opportunity. I know where I am supposed to be and what I am supposed to be doing but there are strangers in my living room.
Sometimes you say the right thing, just when I manage to be near you. It makes me *want* to be near you. I hate following you around and I hate waiting. I want to know everything NOW –
Please?
The hate I see in your eyes, everywhere your eyes go - except into mine.
I like the look in your eyes, as they look into mine. I am rooted to the spot and swimming in you– my shoulders firm, my body gone in pleasure – pouring out…
I want to sit cross-legged on the edge of a bed and look into your eyes and touch every part of your lovely naked body with my fingertips… I want to make love with you without ever losing your gaze… I want to go down on you like you've never had it before, even from a whore, and I know I can too…
I want to stop saying 'I want you'… because I want you… and somehow I am doing something wrong that's pushing you away as I breathe and as I watch your beautiful body fade from my grasp I follow you around – pushing you away before me.

Slide: **Novelty [n.] nov.el.ty 1. The quality of being novel; newness. 2. Something new and unusual; an innovation. 3. A small mass-produced article such as a toy or trinket.**

Alice leans in to whisper into Jack's ear, as if she were praying.

ALICE:
Want me, God Damn it.. Want me so much you can't stay away – just for a little while? Want me so much it makes you a little crazy… and I promise you – I will join you.

Alice enfolds her body around Jack, trying to become one with him.

LIGHTS shift to reveal Katherine and Christopher.

CHRISTOPHER:
What do you suppose they're doing now?

KATHERINE:
Fucking -

Christopher holds his hand gently over Katherine's mouth to stop her speech.
Then he turns his back to her, leaving Katherine alone, straining to hear any sound that may come from Alice and Jack's bedroom.

SCENE TWELVE

LIGHTS UP on Mother at her podium.
She appears restless, not quite her usual controlled self.

Slide: **Lecture Three: The New Bride.**

MOTHER:
The bride who is a stranger, but whose husband is well known in the town to which he brings her will have her – the husband's friends - call on her – - rather, she will call on them – he will call on her…
but then it devolves upon *her* to make herself liked…
otherwise she will find herself in a community of many acquaintances, but no friends.
She hasn't called me back in eight days.

Mother pauses, lost in thought – shaken. She snaps herself out of it.

MOTHER:
The best ingredients for likeableness are a happy, positive outlook, an unaffected manner, and a sympathetic attitude – towards everyone – especially her elders. If she is fortunate enough to posses these attributes, the young woman will have roses enough. ***But*** – a young woman with an affected pose and bad or *conceited* manners will find plenty of thorns. Oh yes, she shall!
Take her – the one with the chip on her shoulder who, coming from New York…
… from New York, for instance, to live in Northampton insists upon dragging skyscrapers into every comparison with her new towns' six-storied buildings. She might as well go back where she came from!
Nor should the bride from Northampton – who has married a once Connecticut Yankee in New Yorks' social court - he calls himself a New Yorker – HA –
… neither should *he* flaunt those standards or customs and tell Mrs. Worldly that she does not approve of her smoking! Maybe he - she doesn't – that's right – she may be right – and she should not, under the circumstances, smoke herself… but she should not make a – display – of intolerance… or she too had better take the first train home since she is likely to find New York a very – very – lonely - place.

Mother is suddenly deeply and intensely moved.

MOTHER:
So endeth the lesson.

[and the last ten pages…]:

SCENE EIGHTEEN

Slide: **Rage**

Alice enters very drunk. She carries a bottle and continues to drink.

ALICE:
And I thought you were special. I thought there were special people left. But I was deceived by my own desire to find them. I was deceived by my own passion. There is no greater deception.
And I can say – I feel like Woody Allen in 'Manhattan'. Personal integrity, he says, is all we have. Mean what you say, and say what you mean. But then I remember that Woody had secret relations with Soon Yi for oh so many years, and I have to pause. Hmmm, I say. Hmmmmm. Who the hell are you anyway? You touch me. We kiss –
And you know, when the pizza man on 20th and 1st Avenue is more attentive to you than the men in your life? - you must now there's something wrong. I have to look in the mirror right now, to remind myself that yes, I do exist and yes, I am beautiful. I am beautiful – even if you choose not to see it that way.

'I hope it's nothing pressing or important', he says on the end of the line to my automated voice, and I suddenly know that he doesn't WANT anything pressing OR important so *I* am CERTAINLY NOT GOING TO GIVE IT TO HIM. Fuck that, baby. No way. You fuck. You are not what you seem to be. I want to remember this rage, remember this rage, remember this rage because that was NOT me in his bed, that was NOT me in that conversation. I am NOT that small. I refuse to be. I'm going to work my way out of this thing NOW before I become what I am not. A HYPOCRITE. How hypocritical!

And what am I supposed to do now, with this soiled love? With these bandages caked hard? Am I supposed to take a trip cross-country, down the roads *you* think I ought to see. Throwing past lives into the Grand Canyon at 6:56am? Philosopher-king! HA! Somebody wake this girl UP! I think she took a little too much of the Cinderella potion and now she's fallen on her face while tripping over the glass slipper. Not only did I leave it *out* for you, I fucking put my name all over it, and attached absolutely *no strings* - and you look at it and say, 'I hope it's nothing pressing'...

I want things *my* way. I don't know how it feels to have that kind of satisfaction. I am angry because all day and all night long I walk around SCREAMING and all day and all night long people tell me to be quiet – to lower my voice.
FUCK YOU for asking me to play only by your rules, formulated from a set of equations that do not pertain to any of my numbers without so much as ever attempting to figure out what my own private math equals to. You have been selfish. FUCK YOU for telling me you hurt more than I do because you **think** – that is the biggest bunch of bullshit I have ever heard. FUCK YOU for deciding my life on my behalf without ever presenting me with the choices I may have to make. They were my choices too.
FUCK YOU JACK!

Katherine enters.

KATHERINE:
Feel better now?

Alice glares at Katherine – if looks could kill.

ALICE:
Fuck you too.

KATHERINE:
I had no intention –

ALICE:
DON'T – you dare.

Alice leaves. Jack enters, watching Alice go. He turns to Katherine.

JACK:
She is my earth, my trees, my mountains. And you, you are everything else. I need to be alone, just now.

Jack leaves, in the same direction as Alice. Katherine begins to fall apart.
Christopher enters, equally distraught. He looks at Katherine, and both sit, ashamed.

SCENE NINETEEN

Slide: **The Taming of the Shrew [Part Four].**

CHRISTOPHER [as Petruchio]: Good morrow…

KATHERINE [as Kate]: … something hard of hearing…

CHRISTOPHER [as Petruchio]: You lie - Kate the curst… Myself am moved …

KATHERINE [as Kate]: Moved?

CHRISTOPHER [as Petruchio]: … a moveable?

KATHERINE [as Kate]: A stool…

CHRISTOPHER [as Petruchio]: Sit on me…

KATHERINE [as Kate]: Asses are made to bear…

CHRISTOPHER [as Petruchio]: … and so … it goes

KATHERINE [as Kate]: No such jade me…

CHRISTOPHER [as Petruchio]: Good Kate… I am sorry.

KATHERINE [as Kate]: Buzzard.

CHRISTOPHER [as Petruchio]: Nay… I am a gentleman.

Christopher turns to Katherine, hopeful. She turns to him and finds herself moved.

KATHERINE:
What happened to us, my dear sir? What happened?

Alice enters. Christopher sees her and pulls away from Katherine.

KATHERINE:
A gentleman.

Katherine runs off. Christopher, torn between the two women, follows Katherine.

Slide: **The Opening of a Door…**